

India should disregard NATO threat on doing business with Russia

During Operation Sindoor, the S-400 formed the outermost layer of India's air defence. This is the missile system that India acquired from Russia a few years ago despite the US **threatening sanctions** under **CAATSA** — a law **mandating punitive** measures against countries engaging in “significant transactions” with Russia, North Korea, or Iran. India **made it clear** that it would proceed with the S-400 deal anyway. **Eventually**, the US House **carved out** an India-specific **waiver**. A similar episode is **playing out** again. NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte warned this week that countries like India, China, and Brazil could face secondary **sanctions** if they continue doing business with Russia. This comes as several US **senators** back a new sanctions bill **proposing** a 500 per cent tariff on nations buying Russian goods. US President Donald Trump, too, said this week that the US would **impose** 100 per cent secondary **tariffs** targeting Russia's trade partners if a peace deal with Ukraine did not happen in 50 days.

The Ministry of External Affairs' sharp **rebuttal** on Thursday — **underlining** that the energy requirements of the Indian people are the overriding priority, and **cautioning** against “double standards” — **serves** as a timely **reminder** to the West, particularly Europe, of its own **manoeuvres in pursuit of** energy security. Yes, India was quick to **seize the opportunity** to purchase discounted Russian oil after the West imposed price caps and turned away from it. But while Russia's **emergence** as India's top crude supplier **has** helped **meet** domestic energy demand and **stabilise** prices, it is no secret that a **substantial volume** of refined fuel, derived from the Russian oil imported to India, **is** **ultimately** exported to Europe. A CREA report noted that by late 2024, “**capitalising on** the refining **loophole**”, India had become the EU's largest exporter of oil products. Europe also imported LNG at record levels from Russia last year.

The **sanctions** threat to its trade partners is intended to **choke** Russia's war funding and pressure President Vladimir Putin into agreeing to a **ceasefire**. In doing so, however, the US and NATO risk **undermining** their relationship with one of the world's largest **economies** and an essential **ally** in the Indo-Pacific. The West cannot have it both ways: Penalise India for **pursuing** national interest while **simultaneously** expecting cooperation in regional and global initiatives. **It is high time** the West engaged with India as an equal partner. Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri said on Thursday that there was nothing to worry about even if sanctions were activated because India has expanded its **crude** sourcing **slate**. New Delhi should remain **firm** in pursuing its own path, even as the West **seeks to dictate terms**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where ‘red’ denotes ‘subject’ and ‘blue’ denotes ‘verb’.

Vocabulary

1. **Disregard** (verb) – Ignore, neglect, overlook, dismiss, bypass उपेक्षा करना
2. **Threaten** (verb) – Intimidate, warn, menace, endanger, bully धमकी देना
3. **Sanction** (noun) – Penalty, punishment, restriction, embargo, fine प्रतिबंध
4. **CAATSA** (noun) – The purpose of CAATSA is to impose sanctions on Iran, North Korea, and Russia, primarily due to their actions that are deemed detrimental to U.S. interests अधिनियम (रूस, उत्तर कोरिया, ईरान से लेनदेन पर रोक का अमेरिकी कानून)
5. **Mandate** (verb) – Order, command, direct, decree, authorize आदेश देना
6. **Punitive** (adjective) – Penal, disciplinary, harsh, retributive, corrective दंडात्मक
7. **Make clear** (phrase) – Clarify, explain, assert, express, communicate स्पष्ट करना
8. **Eventually** (adverb) – Ultimately, finally, in the end, sooner or later, at last अंततः
9. **Carve out** (phrasal verb) – Establish, secure, create, extract, obtain प्राप्त करना / अलग करना
10. **Waiver** (noun) – Exemption, release, surrender, renunciation, exception छूट
11. **Play out** (phrasal verb) – Unfold, occur, happen, transpire, develop घटित होना
12. **Sanction** (noun) – Restriction, embargo, penalty, punishment, control प्रतिबंध
13. **Senator** (noun) – Legislator, lawmaker, parliamentarian, representative, congressman सांसद (राज्यसभा/सेनेट का सदस्य)
14. **Propose** (verb) – Suggest, recommend, offer, present, submit प्रस्ताव करना
15. **Impose** (verb) – Enforce, implement, inflict, apply, levy थोपना / लागू करना
16. **Tariff** (noun) – Tax, duty, levy, charge, fee शुल्क / कर
17. **Rebuttal** (noun) – Refutation, denial, counterargument, contradiction, reply खंडन
18. **Underline** (verb) – Emphasize, stress, highlight, point out, reinforce जोर देना
19. **Caution** (verb) – Warn, advise, alert, forewarn, notify चेतावनी देना
20. **Reminder** (noun) – Prompt, cue, nudge, alert, recollection स्मरण
21. **Manoeuvre** (noun) – Strategy, move, tactic, action, operation चाल / रणनीति

22. **In pursuit of** (phrase) – In search of, in quest of, seeking, chasing, aiming for की खोज में
23. **Seize the opportunity** (phrase) – Grab the chance, capitalize, act promptly, take advantage, jump at the opportunity अवसर को पकड़ना
24. **Emergence** (noun) – Rise, appearance, advent, development, formation उदय / प्रकट होना
25. **Meet** (verb) – Fulfil, satisfy, achieve, accomplish, serve पूरा करना
26. **Stabilise** (verb) – Balance, steady, secure, fix, normalize स्थिर करना
27. **Substantial** (adjective) – Significant, considerable, large, major, hefty महत्वपूर्ण / भारी
28. **Ultimately** (adverb) – Eventually, finally, at last, in the end, in conclusion अंततः
29. **Capitalise** (on) (verb) – Exploit, utilize, take advantage, benefit, profit लाभ उठाना
30. **Loophole** (noun) – Gap, escape clause, flaw, exemption, weak point कानूनी छिद्र / बचाव का रास्ता
31. **Sanction** (verb) – Penalize, punish, restrict, embargo, reprimand दंडित करना
32. **Choke** (verb) – Strangle, suffocate, block, suppress, smother दबाना / रोकना
33. **Ceasefire** (noun) – Truce, armistice, suspension, peace, halt युद्धविराम
34. **Undermine** (verb) – Weaken, sabotage, erode, impair, damage कमजोर करना
35. **Economies** (noun) – Countries in terms of GDP अर्थव्यवस्थाएँ
36. **Ally** (noun) – Partner, supporter, associate, collaborator, comrade सहयोगी / मित्र राष्ट्र
37. **Pursue** (verb) – Follow, chase, seek, aim for, engage in पीछा करना / प्रयास करना
38. **Simultaneously** (adverb) – Concurrently, together, at the same time, synchronously, in parallel एक साथ
39. **It is high time** (phrase) – It is overdue, it is the right time, it is appropriate now, it should be done now, delay is enough अब समय आ गया है
40. **Crude** (adjective) – Unrefined, raw, natural, unprocessed, impure कच्चा (जैसे कच्चा तेल)
41. **Slate** (noun) – List, schedule, lineup, roster, catalogue सूची
42. **Firm** (adjective) – Strong, resolute, determined, unwavering, steady दृढ़

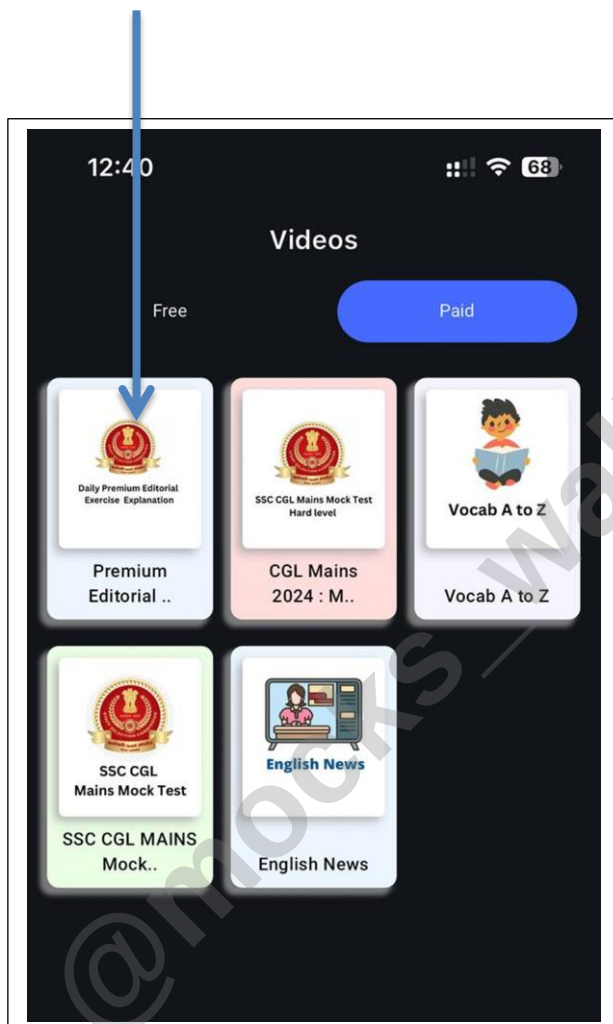
43. **Seek** (verb) – Look for, try to get, strive for,
pursue, request तलाशना

45. **Term** (noun) – Condition, clause, provision,
agreement, stipulation शर्त / अवधि

44. **Dictate** (verb) – Command, order,
prescribe, demand, impose आदेश देना /
नियंत्रण करना

@mocks_wallah

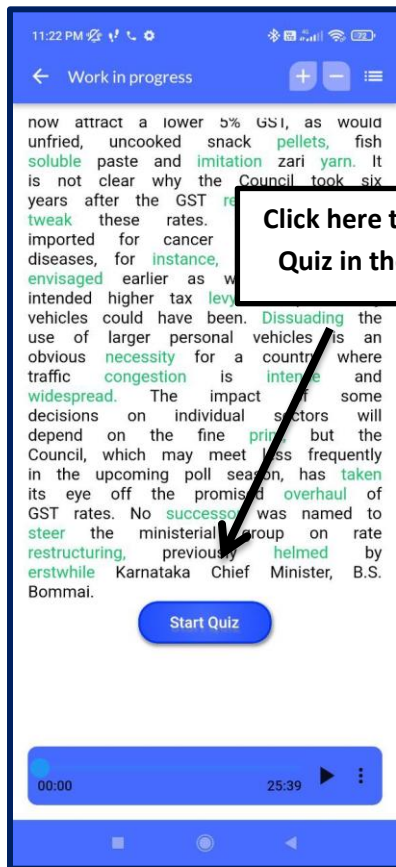
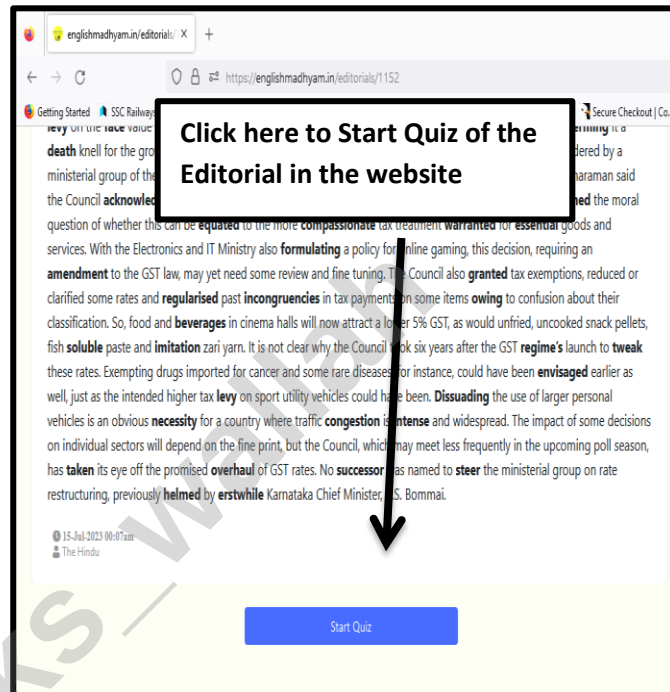
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Summary of the Editorial

1. **India's Independent Defence Choices** – India acquired the Russian S-400 missile system despite U.S. threats of sanctions under CAATSA.
2. **Past U.S. Concession** – The U.S. House eventually carved out an India-specific waiver for the S-400 deal.
3. **Fresh Sanctions Threat** – NATO chief Mark Rutte recently warned of secondary sanctions on countries like India, China, and Brazil for trading with Russia.
4. **U.S. Legislative Pressure** – Several American senators are backing a bill proposing a 500% tariff on nations buying Russian goods.
5. **Trump's Ultimatum** – Donald Trump has threatened 100% secondary tariffs unless a peace deal with Ukraine is reached within 50 days.
6. **India's Diplomatic Response** – India's Ministry of External Affairs strongly defended its energy choices, stressing national interest and condemning Western double standards.
7. **Energy Security Priority** – India prioritised meeting its domestic energy needs by purchasing discounted Russian oil after the West imposed caps.
8. **Refined Exports to Europe** – India re-exports refined products made from Russian oil, much of which is purchased by Europe.
9. **India as EU's Top Fuel Exporter** – A CREA report noted that by late 2024, India had become the EU's largest oil product exporter by exploiting the refining loophole.
10. **Europe's Own Dependence** – Europe continued to import record levels of Russian LNG in 2024 despite public sanctions rhetoric.
11. **Sanctions Goal** – The West aims to cut off Russia's war funding and pressure President Putin into a ceasefire by threatening trade partners.
12. **Diplomatic Fallout Risk** – These actions risk alienating India, a key economic power and strategic partner in the Indo-Pacific.
13. **Double Standards Critique** – The editorial criticizes the West for punishing India's self-interest while expecting partnership on global matters.
14. **Minister's Reassurance** – Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri assured that India has diversified its crude oil sources and is not dependent on any single country.
15. **Call for Strategic Autonomy** – The editorial asserts that India must stay firm and resist Western pressure, continuing to pursue its sovereign economic and strategic interests.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based

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